In fact, the DMK supremo M. Karunanidhi was to address a rally on the same Sriperumbudur temple ground on the same date. But the party's event management team had not asked for the temple ground on time. They had sought police permission on 19 May. The police could not allow two big meetings addressed by such big leaders on the same day in the same town. Eventually, the DMK dropped out and Chandrasekar had her way. And she had insisted on the temple ground, as some of her real estate developer relatives owned it. Rajiv's meeting would have brought it into the limelight.

Rajiv's tryst with destiny didn't end there. After touring Orissa in a helicopter, Rajiv took a chartered plane hired by his party to Vizag in Andhra Pradesh on 21 May. He was to take off for Tamil Nadu by 4.30 p.m. Captain Subhash Chandok was flying him. He found that the 'King Air' plane had developed a communication error. Rajiv, an experienced Boeing pilot himself, looked into the problem and said he felt sorry for 'Aunty Chandrasekar' as he wouldn't be able to attend the political rally in her constituency. The aircraft was not fit for flying—Rajiv would have to spend the night there and return to Delhi the next morning due to no landing or take-off facility at the Vizag airport after 6 p.m.

Shortly, however, the pilot managed to find the required spare part from the ground staff, fixed the communication error and declared that the aircraft was ready to take off. A happy Rajiv himself piloted the aircraft and landed in Madras around 8 p.m—keeping his date with destiny.

The sun got stronger as Anirudhya and his contact sat on the beach, talking. It was rare to see a 'spy' getting emotional about someone's death. Anirudhya returned to the hotel and filed the next instalment of his story under the title 'Tryst with Destiny'.

The call came early in the evening. Copies filed by reporters went to all the editors. Badhwar read Anirudhya's copy and called his hotel. Anirudhya answered in the middle of shaving. Badhwar's message was loud and clear.

'Hey, we sent you to Madras to collect some hard facts that you are known for in your stories. This "tryst with destiny" could have been done by any of the subs here, Anirudhya! Any problem that you are facing in Madras?'